CONTEXT CLUES IN A PASSAGE

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the passage once all the way through. Then complete the table for the six words in capitals, and answer the questions.

For two hundred years, lighthouse keepers lived in some of the most ISOLATED places in the world: on rocks far from shore, where no neighbour lived for miles. Their job was to keep the BEACON burning, a bright light at the top of the tower that warned ships away from the coast at night.

The coast near a lighthouse was usually TREACHEROUS. Hidden rocks, strong currents and sudden fog made it dangerous, and many ships had been wrecked there before the lights were built.

A supply boat brought PROVISIONS a few times a year: flour, oil, dried meat and candles. If storms kept the boat away, the keeper had to make the food last.

Keepers had to be VIGILANT. They watched the sea every night, trimmed the wick, cleaned the glass and wound the clockwork that turned the lamp. A keeper who fell asleep could cost a crew their lives.

Today almost every lighthouse is AUTOMATED. Machines switch the light on at dusk and off at dawn, and nobody needs to live in the tower at all.

Word	What I think it means	The clue that told me
isolated		
beacon		
treacherous		
provisions		
vigilant		
automated		

1. Which type of clue explains BEACON?
   a) a definition in the same sentence b) an antonym c) a nonsense word
2. Why did keepers need to make the food last?
   a) They were greedy. b) Storms could keep the supply boat away.
   c) The shop was closed on Sundays.
3. What is the main idea of the last paragraph?
   a) Lighthouses have been knocked down. b) Keepers still live in every lighthouse.
   c) Machines now do the work keepers used to do.

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CONTEXT CLUES IN A PASSAGE ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

isolated | far away from other people, remote | on rocks far from shore, no neighbour for miles

beacon | a warning light | a bright light at the top of the tower that warned ships

treacherous | dangerous | hidden rocks, strong currents, sudden fog; made it dangerous

provisions | supplies of food and materials | flour, oil, dried meat and candles

vigilant | watchful, alert | watched the sea every night; a keeper who fell asleep …

automated | run by machines, without people | machines switch the light on and off; nobody needs to live there

1. a) a definition in the same sentence 2. b) Storms could keep the supply boat away. 3. c) Machines now do the work keepers used to do.

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